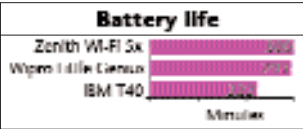


Zenith Premium Wi-Fi 5x Notebook

Copy cat

The Centro-based Wi-Fi 5x makes a mark in the looks department with a silver-grey body and the subtle use of chrome. The keyboard is comfortable, while the touchpad is super-sensitive. The optical drive and the battery can be easily swapped. Build-wise, the laptop is rugged.

It has a Pentium M 1.4 GHz, 128 MB DDR RAM, 30 GB hard disk and a combo-drive. We tested using 256 MB of RAM—and we recommend the upgrade. The Audio DJ lets you listen to CDs without switching on the laptop.



Price: Rs 84,000 (Rs 2,000 extra for an additional 128 MB of RAM)
Contact: Zenith Computers Ltd
Phone: 022-28377300
Fax: 022-28364859
E-mail: laptops@zenith-india.com
Web site: www.zenith-india.com

Maxtor OneTouch 250 GB External Hard Drive

Touch and store

The elegant-looking OneTouch external hard drive is the answer for any storage needs you may have. It has a performance-enhancing 8 MB buffer. The drive



The hard disk performed below par, affecting the overall system scores. In Business Winstone, 5X scored 24 units—three units short of the IBM T40, our winner in the Thin and Light category in the January tests. The graphics sub-system was a disappointment: The 5x was able to extract only 42 fps in *Quake III Arena* at 1,024 x 768. The batteries lasted about five hours, posting the best scores to date by any laptop. At Rs 84,000, the Wi-Fi 5X is a decent buy.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium M 1.4 GHz, 128 MB DDR RAM, Wireless LAN (802.11b), 30 GB hard drive, 15-inch TFT, IR port, card reader, TV-out

Zenith Premium Wi-Fi 5X Notebook		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

7,200-rpm IDE drives. In the file transfer test, this drive outclassed all the other external

disks we've ever tested. It took just 54.54 seconds for the 1 GB write test, as compared to 58.33 seconds for our performance winner, the Freecom FHD-1 40 GB drive. The read speed was also the best amongst all external drives—it took just 47.12 seconds to read a 1 GB file from this drive, as compared to 53.66 seconds for the Freecom. In the CPU utilisation test, it logged 20.3 per cent, the highest we've seen.

The drive comes bundled

Price: Rs 19,500 + taxes
Contact: eSys
E-mail: yogi@maxtor.com
Web site: www.maxtor.com

Real World Assorted Write speed (1 GB file)	
Maxtor OneTouch - 250 GB	54.54 Sec
Freecom FHD - 140 GB	58.33 Sec
* Lower is better	

with Dantz Retrospect, a backup and disaster-recovery software. At Rs 19,500 excluding taxes, it's the cheapest external drive in terms of price per MB.

SPECIFICATIONS

250 GB, 7200 rpm, 8 MB buffer, 1.38 Kg, USB 2.0 and Firewire interface, OneTouch hotkey to launch an application

Maxtor OneTouch 250 GB external hard drive		A
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Microsoft Basic Wireless Optical Desktop

A good combination

This keyboard-mouse combination retains nearly all the features of its more expensive brethren, except for a palm-rest. It has a grey-and-white finish. The keyboard ergonomics are good and the mouse design is ambidextrous. Two AA batteries make the mouse slightly heavy.

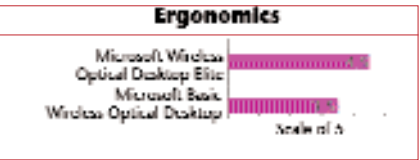
The keyboard has multimedia and one-touch access keys for My Music, My Documents, etc. The function keys can be toggled using [F-lock] to double up as shortcut keys for Copy, Paste, etc. Other features include a logoff button and a recessed Sleep key.

The combo connects to a PC via a small radio receiver. The mouse has USB and PS/2



connectors, but the keyboard only has a PS/2 connector.

At Rs 4,590, it's an excellent, but expensive product.



SPECIFICATIONS

Customisable button, sleep and log-off hotkey, PC and Mac compatible, ambidextrous mouse

Price: Rs 4,590
Contact: Microsoft Corporation (India) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 011-26294600
Fax: 011-26292650
E-mail: connect@microsoft.com

Microsoft Basic Wireless Optical Desktop		A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	